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Occupational Employment Statistics

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Occupational Employment and Wages, May 2017

31-1014 Nursing Assistants

Provide basic patient care under direction of nursing staff. Perform duties such as feed, bathe, dress, groom, or move patients, or change linens. May transfer or transport patients. Includes nursing care attendants, nursing aides, and nursing attendants. Excludes "Home Health Aides" (31-1011), "Orderlies" (31-1015), "Personal Care Aides" (39-9021), and "Psychiatric Aides" (31-1013).

National estimates for this occupation
Industry profile for this occupation
Geographic profile for this occupation

National estimates for this occupation: Top

Employment estimate and mean wage estimates for this occupation:

Employment (1)	Employment RSE (3)	Mean hourly wage	Mean annual wage (2)	Wage RSE (3)
1,453,670	0.5 %	$13.72	$28,540	0.2 %

Percentile wage estimates for this occupation:

Percentile	10%	25%	50% (Median)	75%	90%
Hourly Wage	$9.94	$11.22	$13.23	$15.49	$18.57
Annual Wage (2)	$20,680	$23,330	$27,520	$32,220	$38,630

Industry profile for this occupation: Top

Industries with the highest published employment and wages for this occupation are provided. For a list of all industries with employment in this occupation, see the Create Customized Tables function.

Industries with the highest levels of employment in this occupation:

Industry	Employment (1)	Percent of industry employment	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Nursing Care Facilities (Skilled Nursing Facilities)	594,460	36.66	$13.20	$27,470
General Medical and Surgical Hospitals	365,360	6.64	$14.73	$30,640
Continuing Care Retirement Communities and Assisted Living Facilities for the Elderly	164,580	18.03	$12.84	$26,700
Home Health Care Services	78,940	5.65	$13.08	$27,210
Employment Services	39,300	1.09	$13.88	$28,870

Industries with the highest concentration of employment in this occupation:

Industry	Employment (1)	Percent of industry employment	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Nursing Care Facilities (Skilled Nursing Facilities)	594,460	36.66	$13.20	$27,470
Continuing Care Retirement Communities and Assisted Living Facilities for the Elderly	164,580	18.03	$12.84	$26,700
Specialty (except Psychiatric and Substance Abuse) Hospitals	26,530	10.21	$14.96	$31,120
General Medical and Surgical Hospitals	365,360	6.64	$14.73	$30,640
Home Health Care Services	78,940	5.65	$13.08	$27,210

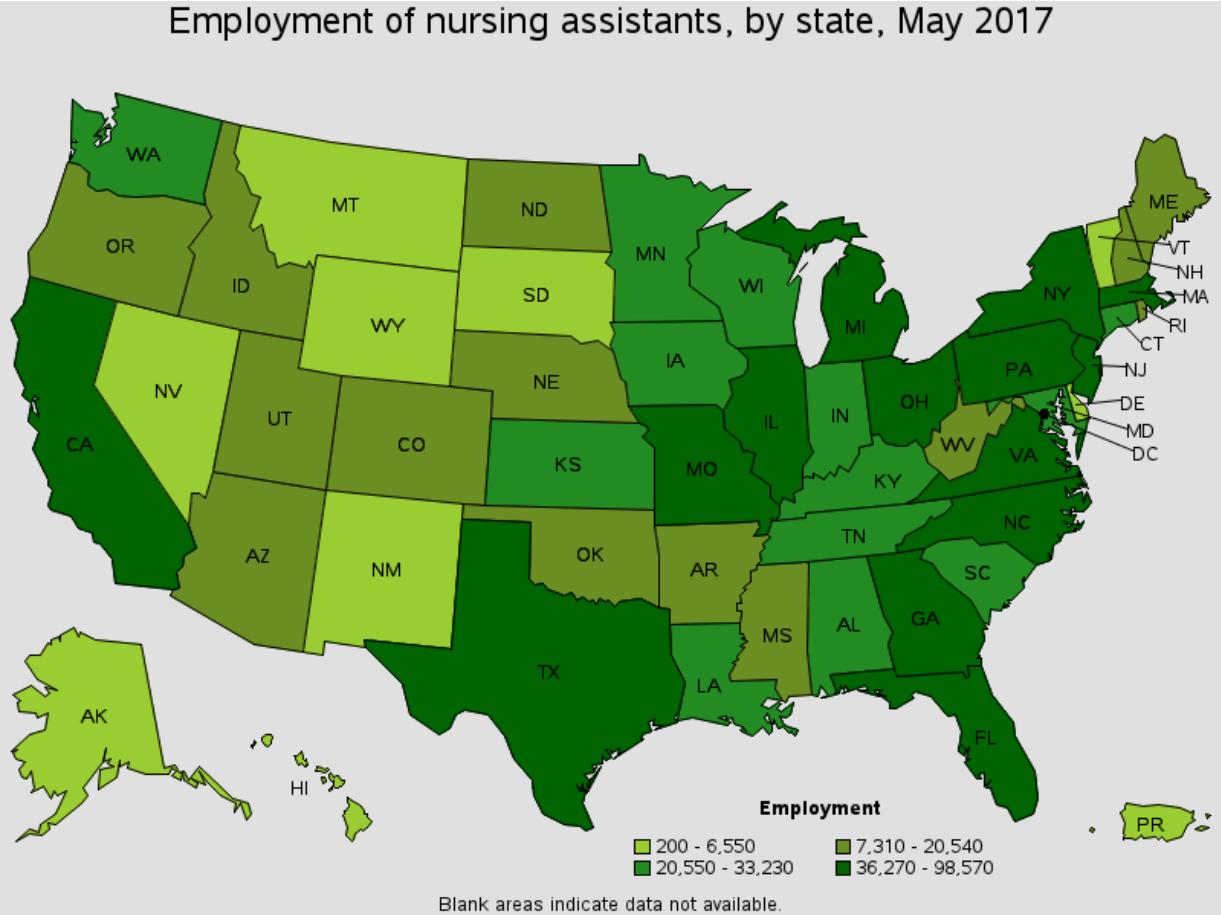
Top paying industries for this occupation:

Industry	Employment (1)	Percent of industry employment	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)

Federal Executive Branch (OES Designation)	14,140	0.70	$18.43	$38,340
Facilities Support Services	30	0.02	$17.88	$37,180
Scientific Research and Development Services	450	0.07	$17.42	$36,240
Educational Support Services	60	0.04	$17.13	$35,630
Colleges, Universities, and Professional Schools	3,110	0.10	$16.49	$34,290

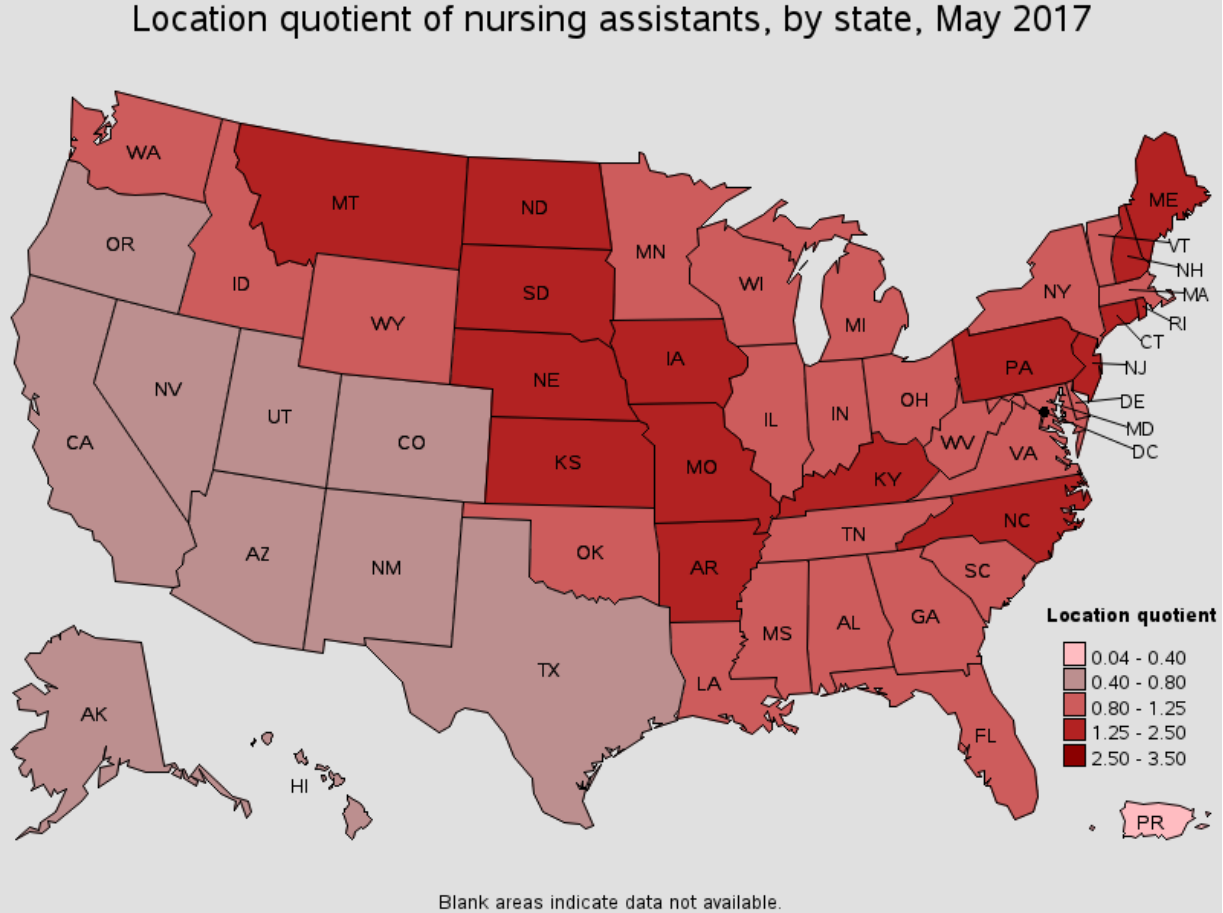
Geographic profile for this occupation: Top

States and areas with the highest published employment, location quotients, and wages for this occupation are provided. For a list of all areas with employment in this occupation, see the Create Customized Tables function.



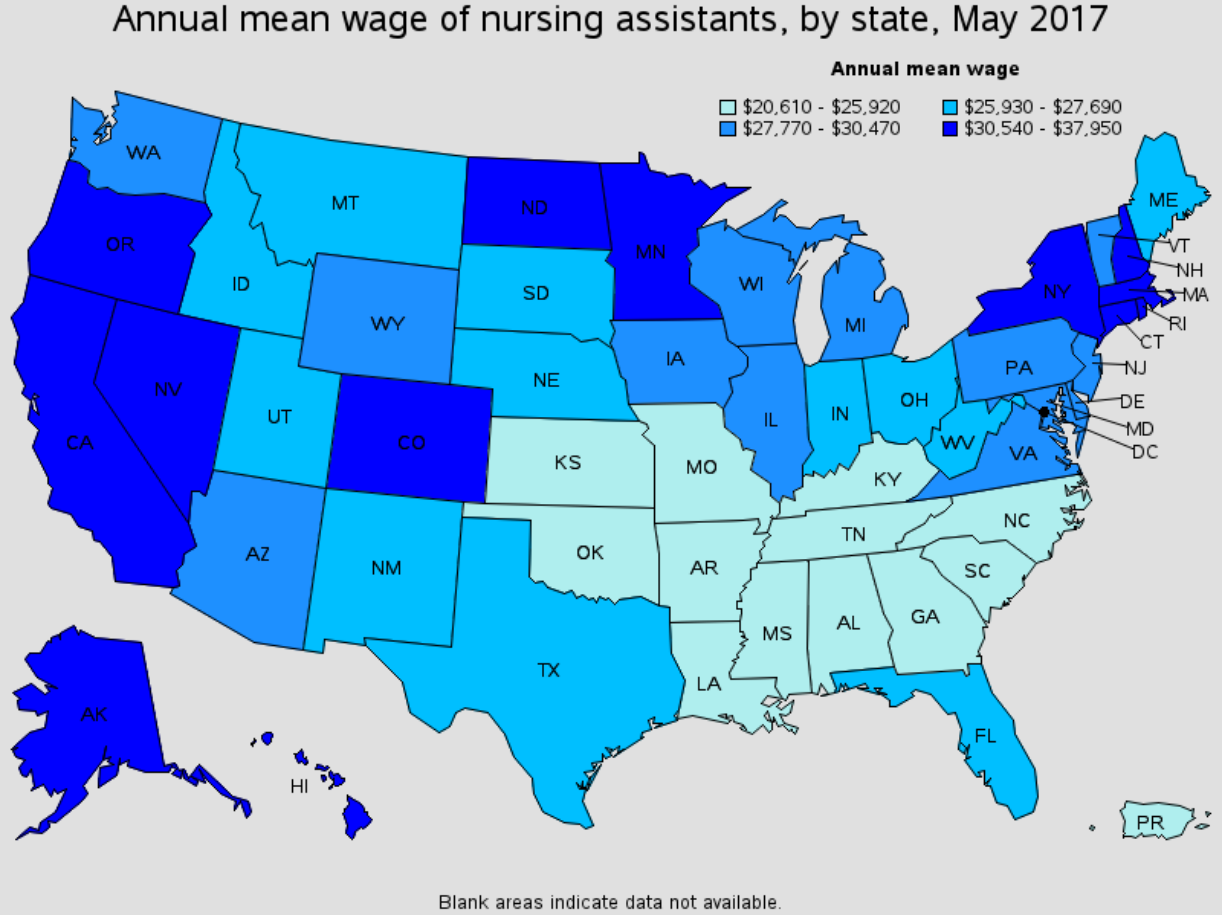
States with the highest employment level in this occupation:

State	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
California	98,570	5.90	0.58	$16.13	$33,560
New York	94,980	10.32	1.01	$16.87	$35,080
Florida	92,190	10.95	1.07	$12.47	$25,930
Texas	88,500	7.44	0.73	$12.69	$26,390
Pennsylvania	75,020	12.97	1.27	$14.43	$30,010



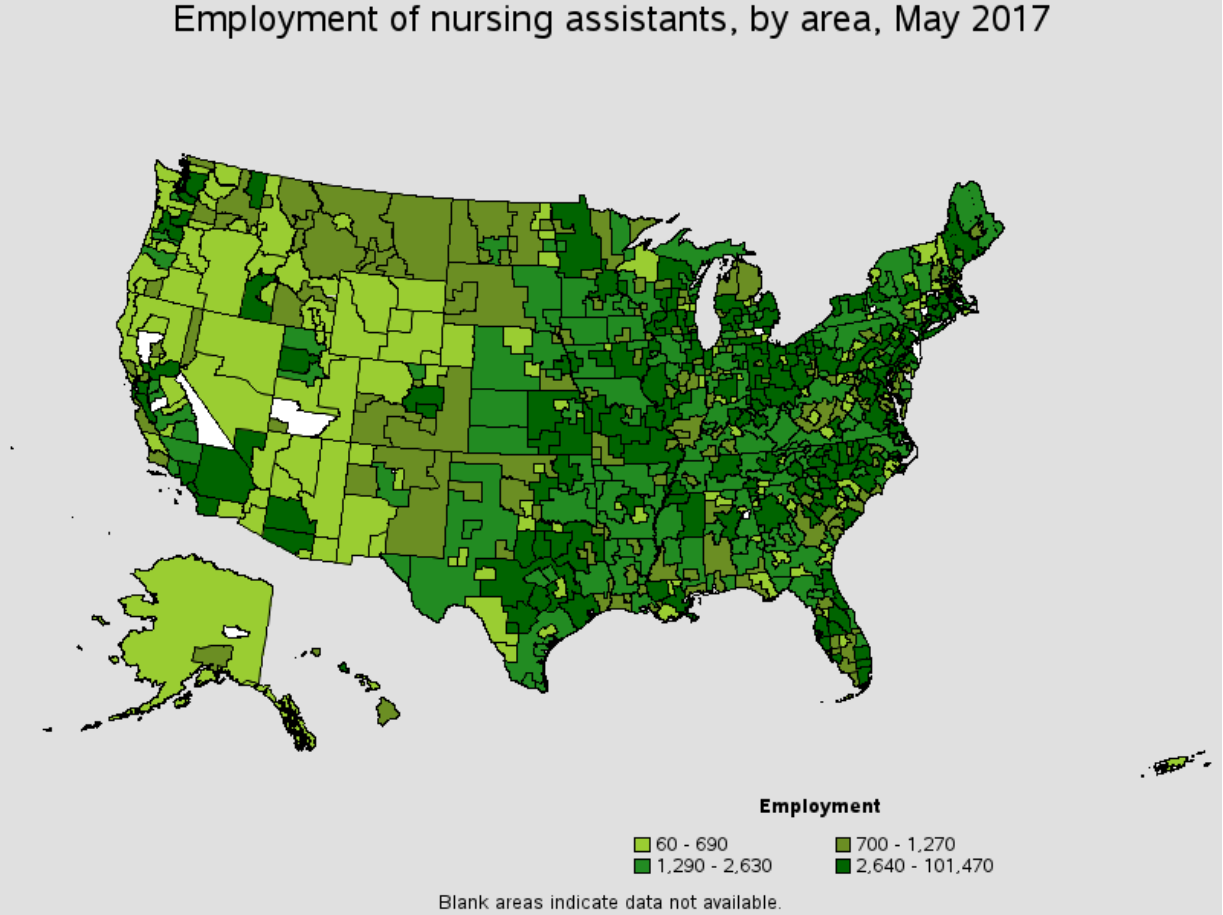
States with the highest concentration of jobs and location quotients in this occupation:

State	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Rhode Island	9,950	20.92	2.05	$14.68	$30,540
North Dakota	7,310	17.53	1.72	$15.81	$32,880
Kansas	22,590	16.50	1.62	$12.16	$25,290
Maine	9,070	15.13	1.48	$13.10	$27,250
Arkansas	18,040	15.03	1.47	$11.53	$23,970



Top paying States for this occupation:

State	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Alaska	1,850	5.81	0.57	$18.24	$37,950
New York	94,980	10.32	1.01	$16.87	$35,080
Nevada	6,550	5.00	0.49	$16.58	$34,480
District of Columbia	3,160	4.46	0.44	$16.43	$34,170
California	98,570	5.90	0.58	$16.13	$33,560



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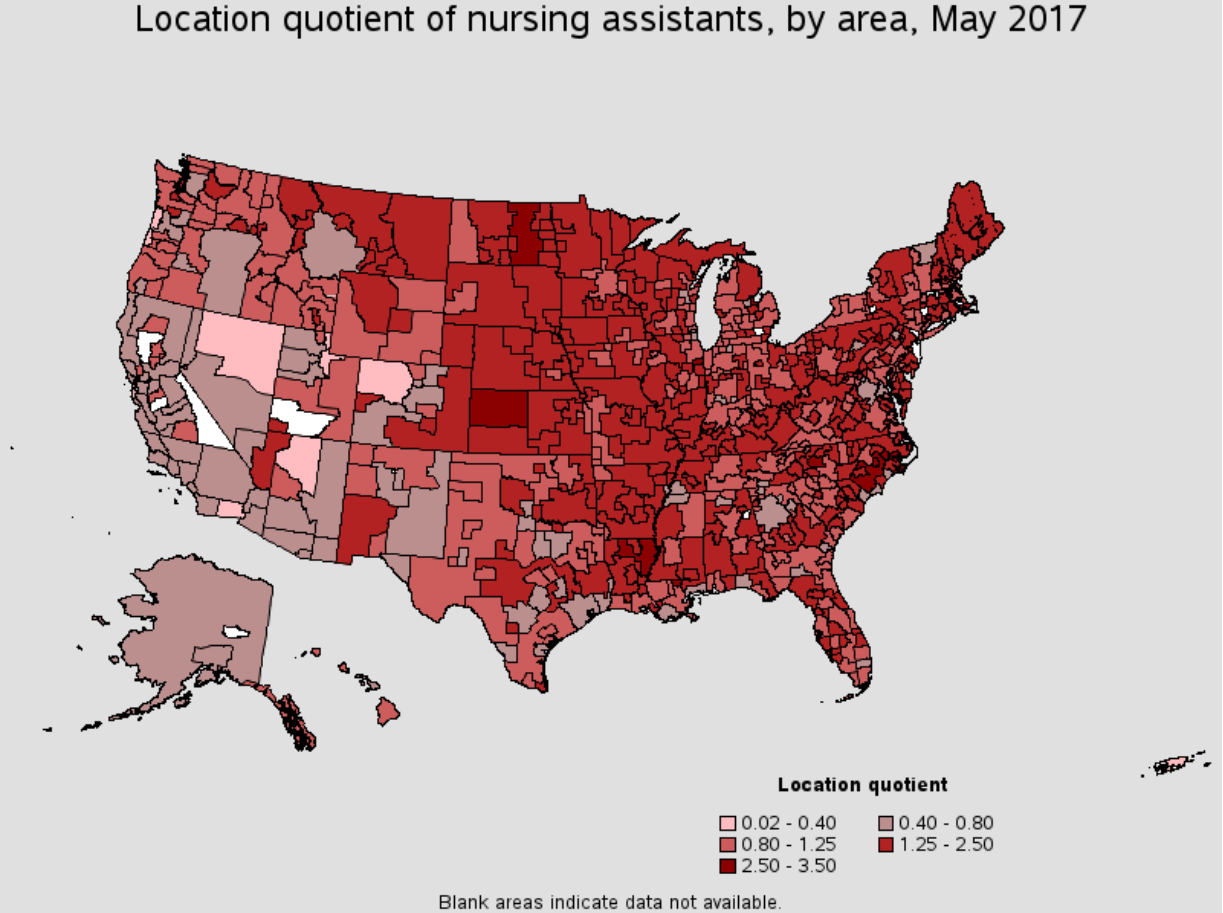
Metropolitan areas with the highest employment level in this occupation:

Metropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
New York-Jersey City-White Plains, NY-NJ Metropolitan Division	69,910	10.44	1.02	$17.06	$35,480
Los Angeles-Long Beach-Glendale, CA Metropolitan Division	32,430	7.32	0.72	$15.10	$31,400
Chicago-Naperville-Arlington Heights, IL Metropolitan Division	31,170	8.51	0.83	$14.01	$29,130
Atlanta-Sandy Springs-Roswell, GA	19,000	7.25	0.71	$12.80	$26,630
St. Louis, MO-IL	18,970	13.98	1.37	$12.87	$26,770
Houston-The Woodlands-Sugar Land, TX	18,660	6.37	0.62	$13.34	$27,750
Minneapolis-St. Paul-Bloomington, MN-WI	17,410	9.01	0.88	$16.47	$34,250
Tampa-St. Petersburg-Clearwater, FL	16,200	12.65	1.24	$12.88	$26,790
Washington-Arlington-Alexandria, DC-VA-MD-WV Metropolitan Division	16,060	6.37	0.63	$14.92	$31,040
Newark, NJ-PA Metropolitan Division	15,640	13.41	1.31	$14.42	$29,990



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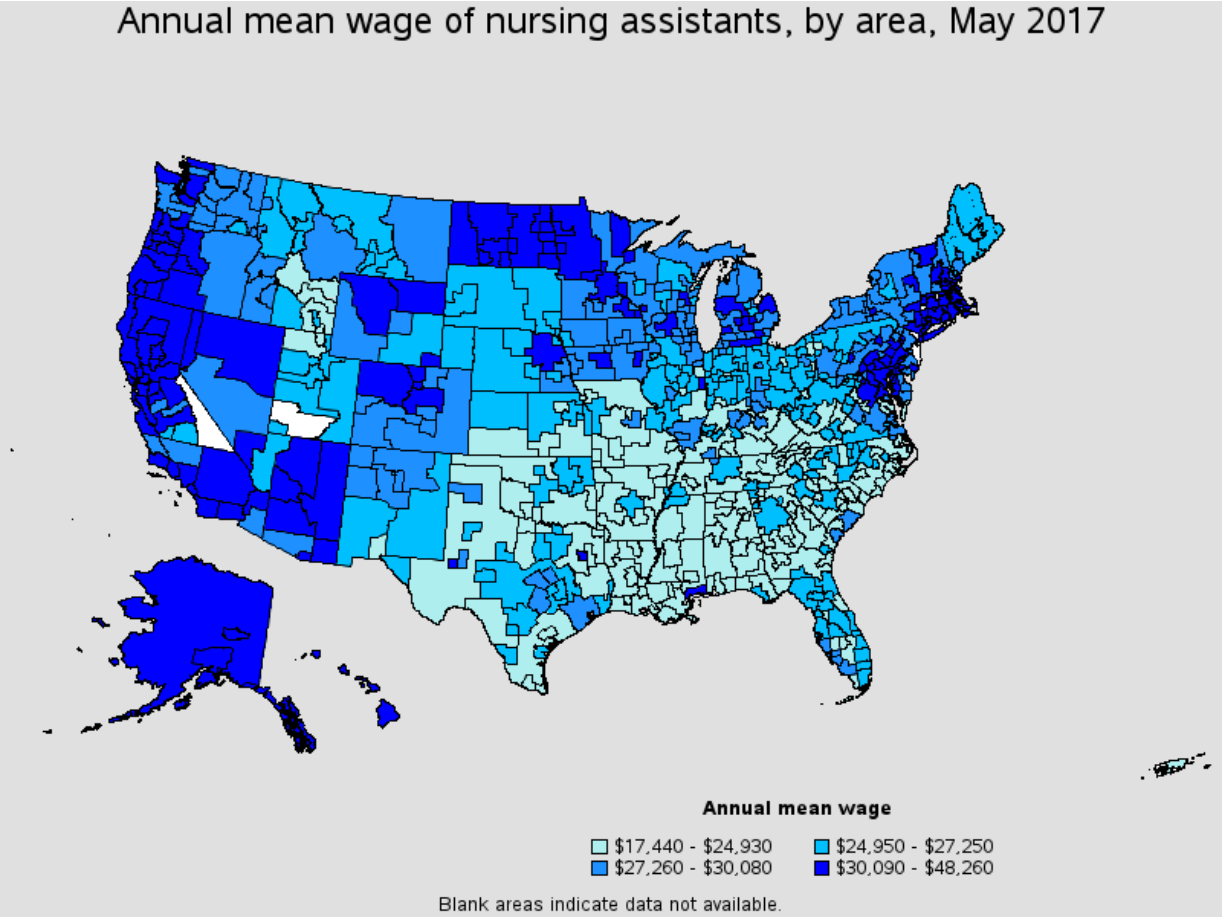
Metropolitan areas with the highest concentration of jobs and location quotients in this occupation:

Metropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Goldsboro, NC	1,200	30.75	3.02	$12.71	$26,440
Hickory-Lenoir-Morganton, NC	4,200	27.31	2.68	$12.69	$26,390
Kankakee, IL	1,170	26.51	2.60	$13.33	$27,730
Bloomsburg-Berwick, PA	1,130	26.46	2.60	$14.70	$30,580
Greenville, NC	1,970	26.38	2.59	$12.23	$25,450
Bay City, MI	870	25.44	2.50	$13.75	$28,590
Florence, SC	2,050	24.12	2.37	$11.76	$24,460
Walla Walla, WA	570	22.75	2.23	$12.75	$26,530
Weirton-Steubenville, WV-OH	820	22.15	2.17	$11.54	$24,000
Asheville, NC	4,200	21.95	2.15	$12.79	$26,610



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Top paying metropolitan areas for this occupation:

Metropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
San Francisco-Redwood City-South San Francisco, CA Metropolitan Division	3,950	3.54	0.35	$23.20	$48,260
Salinas, CA	840	4.90	0.48	$21.68	$45,100
Fairbanks, AK	(8)	(8)	(8)	$19.45	$40,450
Nassau County-Suffolk County, NY Metropolitan Division	14,380	11.03	1.08	$19.00	$39,520
Tyler, TX	1,270	12.62	1.24	$18.47	$38,410
San Jose-Sunnyvale-Santa Clara, CA	5,080	4.66	0.46	$18.47	$38,410
Yuba City, CA	420	9.71	0.95	$18.12	$37,690
Anchorage, AK	1,040	5.99	0.59	$17.79	$36,990
Sacramento--Roseville--Arden-Arcade, CA	5,450	5.68	0.56	$17.62	$36,640
Flagstaff, AZ	210	3.38	0.33	$17.49	$36,380

Nonmetropolitan areas with the highest employment in this occupation:

Nonmetropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Southeast Coastal North Carolina nonmetropolitan area	6,350	25.67	2.52	$10.71	$22,270
Piedmont North Carolina nonmetropolitan area	5,370	20.95	2.05	$12.09	$25,140
North Northeastern Ohio non-metropolitan area (non-contiguous)	5,280	15.91	1.56	$12.44	$25,870
West Central Illinois nonmetropolitan area	3,650	21.22	2.08	$12.09	$25,150

Southeast Missouri nonmetropolitan area	3,500	21.32	2.09	$11.04	$22,970

Nonmetropolitan areas with the highest concentration of jobs and location quotients in this occupation:

Nonmetropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Northwest Kansas nonmetropolitan area	1,750	29.39	2.88	$12.22	$25,430
Washington Parish, Louisiana nonmetropolitan area	280	29.31	2.87	$8.57	$17,830
East Central North Dakota nonmetropolitan area	1,070	26.57	2.61	$15.40	$32,040
Northeast Louisiana nonmetropolitan area	1,730	26.33	2.58	$9.15	$19,030
Southeast Coastal North Carolina nonmetropolitan area	6,350	25.67	2.52	$10.71	$22,270

Top paying nonmetropolitan areas for this occupation:

Nonmetropolitan area	Employment (1)	Employment per thousand jobs	Location quotient (9)	Hourly mean wage	Annual mean wage (2)
Southeast Alaska nonmetropolitan area	300	8.53	0.84	$19.39	$40,320
North Valley Region of California nonmetropolitan area	(8)	(8)	(8)	$19.11	$39,750
Nantucket Island and Martha's Vineyard nonmetropolitan area	90	4.89	0.48	$18.48	$38,450
Balance of Alaska nonmetropolitan area	420	5.90	0.58	$17.84	$37,100
North Coast Oregon nonmetropolitan area	150	3.45	0.34	$16.89	$35,120

About May 2017 National, State, Metropolitan, and Nonmetropolitan Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

These estimates are calculated with data collected from employers in all industry sectors, all metropolitan and nonmetropolitan areas, and all states and the District of Columbia. The top employment and wage figures are provided above. The complete list is available in the downloadable XLS files.

The percentile wage estimate is the value of a wage below which a certain percent of workers fall. The median wage is the 50th percentile wage estimate--50 percent of workers earn less than the median and 50 percent of workers earn more than the median. More about percentile wages.

(1) Estimates for detailed occupations do not sum to the totals because the totals include occupations not shown separately. Estimates do not include self-employed workers.

(2) Annual wages have been calculated by multiplying the hourly mean wage by a "year-round, full-time" hours figure of 2,080 hours; for those occupations where there is not an hourly wage published, the annual wage has been directly calculated from the reported survey data.

(3) The relative standard error (RSE) is a measure of the reliability of a survey statistic. The smaller the relative standard error, the more precise the estimate.

(8) Estimate not released.

(9) The location quotient is the ratio of the area concentration of occupational employment to the national average concentration. A location quotient greater than one indicates the occupation has a higher share of employment than average, and a location quotient less than one indicates the occupation is less prevalent in the area than average.

Other OES estimates and related information:

May 2017 National Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2017 State Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2017 Metropolitan and Nonmetropolitan Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2017 National Industry-Specific Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates

May 2017 Occupation Profiles

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